

Feasibility Studies for the New Project Wave

Immediate hands-on help on the projects starting now — and, growing out of that work, one lasting way of doing feasibility studies. Two streams, one goal.

DISCUSSION DRAFT — FOR INTERNAL REVIEW

01 • SITUATION & GOALS

A wave of projects is starting — feasibility can't keep up

A lot of new projects are heading for the starting line. Entering the delivery phase without a quality feasibility study puts the investment at risk: gaps in scope, cost, capacity and risk surface only when changing course is already expensive.

The feasibility stage is the **last inexpensive decision point**: the one moment where an initiative can still be confirmed, reshaped or stopped at the cost of a study rather than the cost of delivery.

Two goals, served together

1

Projects starting now get feasibility studies in decision quality

Concrete, immediate help where the pressure is: hands-on support on selected projects at the start of the wave — no lengthy analysis phase before help arrives.

2

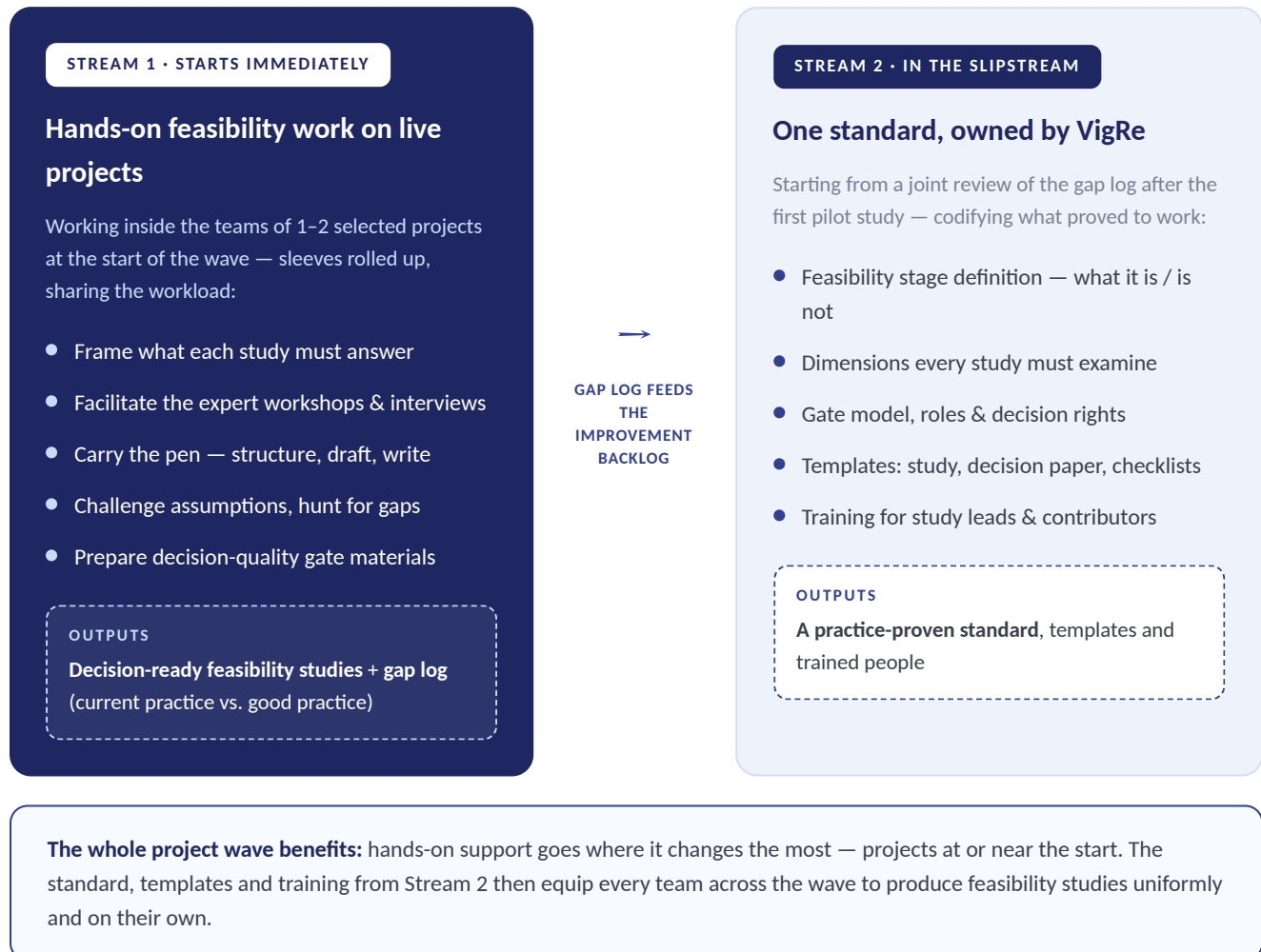
VigRe builds a lasting capability to do this itself

Out of the real work grows one shared standard — content, roles, decision gate — so every future study is done uniformly, by VigRe's own teams.

Longer-term outlook: once studies follow one standard they become comparable across initiatives — over future planning cycles this enables better portfolio prioritisation and more informed allocation of funds. No change to the current planning process is required.

Two streams, one system

We don't start with a methodology binder. We start in the field — helping selected starting projects produce their feasibility studies — and we let the standard grow out of what that work teaches us.



Hands in the dirt, not an advisory board

Not a review committee, not remote quality assurance. Our consultant works inside the project team as extra capacity and extra know-how — so the study gets done, and done well, without exhausting the team.

Framing the assignment

With the sponsor and the team we pin down what exactly the study must answer, which options are on the table, who the experts are — the step where most studies silently go wrong.

Carrying the workload

We facilitate the workshops and interviews, provide the frame for cost and capacity views, and take on the drafting and writing. The team supplies business knowledge and numbers.

Independent challenge

Unbiased stress-testing of assumptions: forgotten run costs, unconfirmed capacities, ignored dependencies — the questions a busy internal team rarely gets to ask itself.

Decision-quality finish

The study and its gate materials are edited into a document management can actually decide on — and the study lead is coached throughout, so the know-how stays in the team.

Why selected projects, not all of them

Hands-on support concentrates where it changes the most: **projects at or near their start**, where the feasibility study still shapes the decision. Projects already further along have passed that window — for them, the templates, checklists and trained colleagues from Stream 2 are the right vehicle. And the project teams exist and stay in the lead: we extend their capacity and know-how compared to today — we do not take the work away from them.

Selection criteria for the 1–2 pilots: at or near the start • a team willing to work this way • ideally two different types of initiative.

OUR GUARDRAILS

We carry workload, never the verdict. Business content, numbers and the go / no-go decision remain fully VigRe's — our signature is on quality, structure and completeness. And our involvement is designed to shrink: the first study is guided closely; by the next one, the team leads and we support.

THE GAP LOG — STREAM 1'S SECOND DELIVERABLE

Alongside the studies themselves, a structured record of every point where current practice diverges from good practice — missing inputs, unclear roles, unconfirmed capacities, undefined decision rights. One live list, maintained as we work. It makes the Stream 2 backlog factual: not somebody's opinion, but what the real projects showed.

Turning the lessons into VigRe's own standard

Stream 2 begins with a single, low-commitment step: **after the first pilot study, we sit down together over the gap log** and decide what is worth fixing systematically. What follows is shaped by that review — the outline below shows the full possible scope.

Possible delivery content

- **Stage definition** — what a feasibility study is and is not at VigRe, which initiatives need one and in what depth
- **Feasibility dimensions** — the checklist of what every study examines
- **Gate model and roles** — the decision moment and a clear RACI: who sponsors, leads, contributes, decides
- **Templates and artefacts** — study document, gate decision paper, checklists, cost & capacity skeletons — seeded from the pilots, so they fit reality on day one
- **Training and handover** — so the standard is a capability, not a document

What VigRe gains

One language, uniform quality — every initiative examined and presented the same way. **Scale without external help** — the standard equips all teams across the wave. **A clean handover into delivery** — study outputs feed straight into project initiation. **A standard that fits** — distilled from VigRe's real projects, not imported from a textbook shelf.

05 • TO VALIDATE TOGETHER

Hypotheses we start from — and questions to verify

This outline is built on our current understanding. Before shaping anything further, we want to validate the following openly — corrections are welcome.

-
- Q1** **What state is the project wave actually in?** Which initiatives are genuinely before or at their start, which are already in flight — and where is the feasibility gap felt most urgently?
-
- Q2** **Which one or two projects are the right pilots?** Suggested criteria: at or near the start, a team willing to work this way, ideally two different types of initiative.
-
- Q3** **Is "feasibility study" an established term today?** Do departments mean the same thing by it — same scope, outputs and decision rights?
-
- Q4** **Is internal capacity part of feasibility today?** Are internal experts, IT capacity and business involvement assessed before an initiative is committed?
-
- Q5** **Who should own the standard and the gate?** Which role or body is the natural owner of the feasibility standard — and who realistically sits at the gate decision?
-

What a feasibility study is — reference

Note on sources: this appendix reflects generally recognised good practice as described by established international standards — PMI / PMBOK, PRINCE2 and the Stage-Gate® model — not a consultant's private view of what a feasibility study should contain.

A feasibility study is a structured pre-project examination of a proposed initiative, answering one question: **is this worth doing, in this form, now — and under what conditions?** Its output is a decision paper for a gate — a recommendation of go / no-go / go-with-conditions with a validated scope outline, cost and benefit estimate, capacity view, key risks and delivery approach. A cost accuracy of $\pm 30\text{--}50\%$ is normal at this stage; the point is a conscious decision, not precision.



Dimension	Key question
Business / strategic	What problem does this solve, how does it link to strategy, what are the benefits and options — including "do nothing"?
Technical	Can it be built and integrated with reasonable risk? Does it fit the architecture?
Economic	What is the total cost of ownership — including run costs after delivery — and does the benefit justify it?
Operational / organisational	What does it change for processes and people, and is the organisation ready to absorb it?
Capacity & resources	Are the internal experts, IT capacity and business involvement actually available in the required period?
Legal / compliance / risk	What are the regulatory implications and the key risks, and can they be managed?
Schedule & delivery	Is the timeline realistic, what does it depend on, and what delivery model fits?

What a feasibility study is not: not a detailed analysis or specification (that belongs to the project itself); not a vendor selection (procurement is a separate step after approval); not an alibi ("we have a study, so we proceed" defeats the purpose — a *no* or a *not-yet* is a legitimate outcome); and not a one-size ritual (the depth scales with the size and risk of the initiative).